ENGLAND FOOTBALL

COMMUNITY PILLAR · HELP & SUPPORT GUIDE

Community

Everything currently available to help clubs connect with their community, evidence their impact, secure funding and tell their story.

How to use this guide: each numbered block is one source of support. Text in **teal** › is a link you can click to open. Everything except block 1 is in **the PlayBook**.

1 Stakeholder Cribsheet

ONLINE PUBLICATION

A quick-reference cribsheet on the stakeholders clubs work with. **Read the Stakeholder Cribsheet ›**

2 Building Common-Unity in your club

WORKSHOP & RESOURCES

A practical, interactive workshop that helps England Football Accredited clubs strengthen their role in the communities they serve. It introduces the principles of Asset Based Community Development (ABCD): identifying and making the most of the people, facilities, partnerships, skills and opportunities that already exist around the club.

WHAT IT EXPLORES

- Building meaningful community connections.
- Partnerships with schools, education providers and local organisations.
- Accessing funding opportunities.
- Demonstrating the wider social impact the club creates.

WHAT CLUBS DO ON THE DAY

- Map the assets in their local area.
- Identify partnership opportunities.
- Consider possible funding sources.
- Start a practical community action plan tailored to their club.

3 Build My Bid

PLAYBOOK

FUNDING SUPPORT SERVICE

Helps clubs strengthen funding applications and increase their chances of securing investment, using data, AI-powered tools and specialist bid-writing expertise.

BUILD MY BID GUIDANCE

For County FAs, FA Club Consultants and Accredited Clubs. Explains how to access and use the service:

- Eligibility requirements.
- The Expression of Interest (EOI) process.
- The tiers of support available.

Complete the Build My Bid EOI form ›

Tip: impact reporting can support funding bids, so a Club Impact Report (block 4) is useful evidence to bring to an application.

4 Club Impact Calculator

PLAYBOOK

MEASURE AND EVIDENCE IMPACT

A structured tool that helps clubs measure, evidence and communicate their social and economic impact, producing a tailored, SROI-style Club Impact Report.

HOW IT WORKS

- Clubs enter key data: teams, participants, workforce, facilities and income.
- Optional member surveys and case studies add deeper insight.
- The report shows value across social, economic, health, wellbeing and community outcomes.
- Use it for funding bids, facility projects, partnerships, local authority engagement and strategic planning.

TWO GUIDES

Technical Expertise: purpose, requirements and benefits, for Club Consultants, County FAs and club leaders.

User Guide: step by step, from entering data and running surveys to customising and analysing the report.

OVER THE PAGE 5 Communications and marketing: workshop, social media planner, website checklist and 11-a-side team

5 Communications and marketing

WORKSHOP & RESOURCES

Effective Communications and Marketing workshop

An introductory workshop that helps clubs develop clearer communications and stronger marketing: engaging different audiences, building a recognisable brand, choosing the right channels and creating marketing that supports the club's wider objectives.

THE BASICS
The difference between communications and marketing, who the club is trying to reach, and what it wants to say.

THE TOOLS
Brand identity, audience targeting, communication platforms and marketing campaigns.

THE PEOPLE
Why building a volunteer team to support communications and marketing matters.

RESOURCES TO USE AFTER THE WORKSHOP

PLANNING TEMPLATE

Club Communications & Social Media Planner

Helps clubs organise, schedule and improve their communications and social media activity.

COVERS

Planning posts, audiences, key messages, platforms, calls to action and link tracking, plus a planning section linking campaigns, themes, responsibilities, budgets and measures of success to the club's development vision.

CHECKLIST

10 Things Your Website Should Have

The essential features of an effective, engaging and professional club website.

COVERS

Contact information, volunteering opportunities, social media links, sponsor visibility, facilities promotion and news content, to strengthen the club's digital presence and support growth.

PLANNING TOOL

Effective Communications 11-a-side Team

Uses the analogy of a football team to help clubs build an effective communications and marketing function.

COVERS

The platforms, roles and capabilities needed: website, social media, email marketing, photography, data management and content creation, with practical tips to grow reach.